

2.2.20 Lead-out

This refers to the additional information written after the actual data to inform the drive about the completion of the session. Without this information, the device would continue to search the disc for additional data, as happens when a session is interrupted.

2.2.21 Overburning

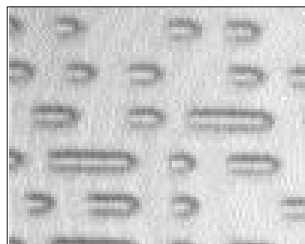
Every writeable optical disc has a maximum stated capacity. Overburning refers to the practice of writing more data than the stated capacity. In some cases, the disc has the capacity to accommodate overhead information, and this area can be written to by overburning. The procedure can, however, be risky, since it could render the disc and/or the drive unusable.

2.2.22 Packet Writing

This is a specialised way of writing onto optical media that allows data to be erased and written to without the limitations imposed by normal optical media writing. Unlike normal writing, where writing can be performed only in sessions and deleting a session does not free space unless the drive is erased, packet writing allows data to be written and erased from optical media just as in the case of floppy disks. To be able to use packet writing, the drive should be compatible with the Mount Rainier specifications of the UDF file format, and the media needs to be specially formatted under the Mount Rainier format.

2.2.23 Pits and Lands

In pre-recorded optical drives, data is stored in the form of depressions on the track. The depressions or pits, and the non-pitted area or Land are interpreted as binary digits (0s and 1s).



Pits and lands litter CD surfaces

2.2.24 Read / Write Head

The Read / Write head of an optical drive consists of a laser emitting diode, a lens, and an optical sensor. The lens focuses the laser beam